

ENTRY-LEVEL SEDANS

TATA INDIGO NOTCHBACK ▼

Rs 4-5 lakh (approx)

Specifications: LxWxH (mm):

3995x1620 x1540; 1.4 petrol 84 bhp;

1.4 diesel, 70 bhp

USP: A chopped boot and a less bulbous bumper mean it will comply with the excise duty reduction benefits for small cars.

To compete with: Mahindra Renault Logan, Tata Indigo, Swift, Hyundai Getz Prime



SUZUKI SWIFT SEDAN ▼

Rs 5.5-lakh (approx)

Specifications: 1.3 litre, 87 bhp petrol;

1.3 litre, 75 bhp diesel

USP: A Swift with a boot will replace the Esteem. Fuel efficiency, sporty style and upmarket feel will appeal to the buyer.

To compete with: Ford Ikon, Mahindra-Renault Logan, Hyundai Accent, Tata Indigo



while rival Mercedes-Benz is getting ready to move into a larger plant of its own and will be fast expanding its India-model range.

Volvo Cars has started operations and will have three very different cars in the market this year, a large SUV, a luxury sedan, and now a convertible. But 2008 is going to be the year of two of India's largest automakers, the homegrown Tata Motors and the erstwhile-homegrown Maruti Suzuki. While the former is making all the news because of the Rs 1-lakh car, it is its other products that will be even more crucial, namely the next generation Indica and the new Sumo. Also as crucial will be the speed with which it can get its partnership with Fiat productive and get trouble-free supply of its new generation engines.

With the launch of the Swift and the change of its name, Maruti Suzuki has laid to rest its staid image and 2008 will be a watershed year for India's largest car maker as it tries to hold on to its marketshare. The company has shown that it is prepared to take some bold steps going forward by discontinuing the Zen and it has some more amputations to make in 2008, starting with the Esteem. Not only will it plug the gaps in its model range in

LUXURY SEDANS



MERCEDES-BENZ C-CLASS ▲

Rs 29-31 lakh

Specifications: LxWxH (mm)

4596x1770x1447; 1.8 litre petrol, 185 bhp; 2.2 litre diesel, 180 bhp

USP: Unrivalled snob value in the country. High on luxury and safety. Class leading performance.

To compete with: BMW 3-series, Audi A4, Skoda Superb and Nissan Teana

AUDI A4 ►

Rs 26-28 lakh

Specifications: LxWxH (mm): 4589 x1816x1415; 1.8 litre petrol, 160 bhp; 2 litre diesel, 138 bhp

USP: The best cabin in terms of quality. Equipment list is exhaustive. Cheaper than rivals.

To compete with: BMW 3-series, Mercedes Benz C-Class, Skoda Superb



PREMIUM SEDANS

FIAT LINEA ►

Rs 8 lakh (approx)

Specifications: LxWxH (mm) 3950x1500x1300;

1.4 litre petrol, 77 bhp; 1.4 litre petrol, 120 bhp;

1.3 litre diesel, 90 bhp

USP: Good looking. With powerful 1.3 litre Multijet engine, should be on top of the performance and fuel efficiency charts.

To compete with: Honda City, Suzuki SX4, Chevrolet Optra



VOLKSWAGEN JETTA

Rs 9-11 lakh (approx)

Specifications: LxWxH (mm): 4550x1780x1460; 2 litre petrol, 148 bhp; 2 litre diesel, 167 bhp

USP: New-age VW looks. Expect brilliant build quality and high-performing engines.

To compete with: Chevrolet Optra Magnum, Honda Civic, Toyota Corolla, Skoda Octavia and Mitsubishi Cedia